Sam Patterson

Technical Builder & Communicator

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I've spent 15 years building at the intersection of technology, communication, and community — from founding a tech policy program in DC, to co-founding a venture-backed decentralized marketplace, to writing about Bitcoin before most people had heard of it. Today I build AI-powered tools and write about emerging technology, regularly reaching the front page of Hacker News.

EXPERIENCE

Technical Operations Specialist June 2026 – Present
MessageWrap · Grand Rapids, MI

Co-Founder & Head of Operations 2015 – 2020
OB1 (OpenBazaar) · Remote

- Co-founded and helped build OpenBazaar, an open-source decentralized marketplace using Bitcoin for peer-to-peer commerce
- Raised $9M in venture capital from Andreessen Horowitz and Union Square Ventures
- Served as developer advocate and documentation lead, managing a global open-source community
- Featured in Wired, Forbes, Yahoo Finance; presented at conferences in Prague, Guatemala, New Hampshire

Senior Policy Analyst & Research Fellow 2011 – 2015
Stand Together · Washington DC

- Founded and directed the technology policy program
- Conducted research on how technology policy affects individual well-being
- Created the Crony Chronicles project, a public awareness initiative on political cronyism

Freelance Technical Writer & Voiceover Artist 2020 – Present
Remote

- Technical tutorials and educational content for open-source projects
- Recorded and published audiobooks on Audible
- Blog writing with multiple Hacker News front-page hits

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Resilient Societies Grant — Mercatus Center
2026 — Research on AI and voluntary claim accountability

Apart Labs AI Fellow — Apart Research
Fall 2024 — AI safety research

SELECTED WRITING & RESEARCH

o3 Beats a Master-Level GeoGuessr Player — Even with Fake EXIF Data
#1 on Hacker News

My Grandma Was a Fed — Lessons from Digitizing Hundreds of Hours of Childhood
Hacker News front page

Visualizing Why Bitcoin Can't Work Over HF Radio
Interactive visualization + video

Artificial Advocates: Biasing Democratic Feedback Using AI
3rd place, Apart Hackathon — led to Apart Labs Fellowship

Bitcoin Beginner
One of the first books published about Bitcoin (2013)

Breakdown of All Satoshi's Writings
Analysis with accompanying video

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python · JavaScript · React · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Linux · Git · AI/LLM Integration · WebRTC · Self-hosted Infrastructure · Technical Writing · Developer Advocacy

EDUCATION

General Assembly — Full-Stack Software Engineering Immersive 2024

Alfred University — B.A. Political Science 2010

PRESENTATIONS

Hacker's Congress, Paralelní Polis (Prague) · CryptoEcon Conference (Saigon) · Hillsdale College Free Market Forum · PorcFest XIII (New Hampshire) · Universidad Francisco Marroquín (Guatemala) · Liberty.me